

But its worth noting that high-end usage requires more than just the software, with specialised recording transcoders, workstations and playback instrumentation. Many of which are essential to truly get the most out of the software. The same can be said for Media Composer which is truly designed for high-end cinematic production given its technical requirements: 64 bit Windows or Mac OS X and above operating system, i7 or Quad Core Processors, 16+ GB of RAM for full functionality, NVIDIA Quadro or GeForce graphics cards with minimum dedicated 250 GB of disk space. These are necessary since the software is designed to work with camera's like those from the RED Digital Cinema Company accompanied which allow for 2K and above high resolution images per frame that the software can seamlessly tweak. But if you're using DSLR Full-HD RAW footage you can't expect the same end result although with the full plug-in packages like Boris you might come close. Ultimately, Avid is a professionals software and is something that should be aspired to for only those seriously inclined towards editing as a career.

Apple's Final Cut Pro and Logic Pro

The current version - Final Cut Pro X - has been around for a while now with numerous updates since its initial release. Many users have turned away from Final Cut Pro X due to the radical changes it brought in its wake to the workflow but die-hards have learnt to appreciate and understand the immense utility now available to them. The version can only be used on Mac machines and is available as an app in the iTunes Store for USD 300 or Rs. 18,000/- in a 2.28 GB download installation. This drastically reduced price gives a clear indication of how much more appealing Apple's product is over Avid.

Apple's Final Cut Pro X version 10.1.2 is a lot more easy on the system and designed with the Apple hardware options in mind. The software works on OS X version 10.9.2 and onwards with 8GB of RAM for full functionality which is limited to 4K resolution footage editing. It can work using only basic graphic card options of 1 GB virtual RAM with OpenCL support. The installation disk space is only 3.5 GB but a minimum of 150 GB is recommended for the project files.

The software still lacks online collaborative support or cloud support but is a very user friendly editing suite especially for those people who are already in possession of a Mac machine. The system is the perfect balance between power and affordability that gets even the most ambitious mid-